

Multi-Agent Systems

Orchestrator-Worker · Parallel Execution · Agent Communication · Specialized Workers ·
Production Deployment · Evaluation

WEEK 3 · DAY 20		Saturday, July 25 2026	Day 20 of 84
Sec	Topic	Coverage	
Sec 1	Orchestrator-Worker Architecture	AgentRole, AgentMessage, TaskSpec, AgentResult	
Sec 2	Specialized Worker Agents	RetrievalAgent, GenerationAgent, ValidationAgent	
Sec 3	Orchestrator	4-phase pipeline: parallel P1 + gen + validate + execute	
Sec 4	Parallel Execution Patterns	gather, fan-out, sequential+exit, speculative	
Sec 5	Agent Communication Protocol	AgentBus, MSG_TYPES, trace_id, pub/sub	
Sec 6	Multi-Agent Evaluation	MultiAgentMetrics, SLOs, per-phase latency targets	
Sec 7	Production Deployment	AgentPool, semaphore, FastAPI endpoint, health check	
Sec 8	FAANG Patterns	Google/Microsoft/Amazon/Meta/Netflix multi-agent patterns	
Sec 9	Architect's Lens	When to use, model sizing, failure isolation, stateless	
Sec 10	Exercises + Summary	Timeline tracing, failure injection, model comparison	

TEXT-TO-SQL AGENT COMPLETE (Days 13-20): D13 foundation + D14 vLLM/FastAPI + D15 RAG schema + D16 indexing + D17 hybrid retrieval + D18 generation + D19 single agent loop + D20 multi-agent orchestration (parallel phases, specialized workers, agent pools, production deployment). Multi-agent SLOs: success>95%, latency<4s, retries<15%.

Section 1 — Orchestrator-Worker Architecture

A multi-agent system routes work to specialized agents coordinated by an orchestrator. Agents communicate via typed messages. Each agent has a single role.

```
from enum import Enum
from dataclasses import dataclass, field
import time

class AgentRole(Enum):
    ORCHESTRATOR = "orchestrator"
    RETRIEVAL    = "retrieval"
    GENERATION    = "generation"
    VALIDATION    = "validation"
    CRITIC        = "critic"

@dataclass
class AgentMessage:
    """Unit of communication between agents."""
    sender: AgentRole
    recipient: AgentRole
    msg_type: str          # "task", "result", "error", "clarify", "progress", "cancel"
    payload: dict
    trace_id: str          # shared across ALL agents for one user request
    timestamp: float = field(default_factory=time.time)

@dataclass
class TaskSpec:
    """What the orchestrator hands to a worker agent."""
    trace_id: str
    role: AgentRole
    question: str
    schema_name: str
    tenant_id: str
    context: dict = field(default_factory=dict)
    # context carries outputs from agents that completed before this one

@dataclass
class AgentResult:
    """What a worker agent returns to the orchestrator."""
    trace_id: str
    role: AgentRole
    success: bool
    output: dict
    latency_ms: float
    error: str | None = None
```

Section 2 — Specialized Worker Agents

Each worker does exactly one job. Narrow scope = better prompt = better results. Workers can use different model sizes (small for retrieval/validation, large for generation).

```
class RetrievalAgent(BaseWorkerAgent):
    """SOLE JOB: retrieve + filter schema to exactly what's needed."""
    SYSTEM = (
```

```

        "You are a schema retrieval specialist. Given a question and raw DDL, "
        "identify: needed_tables, relevant_columns, implied_joins, schema_context. "
        "Return JSON: {needed_tables, relevant_columns, implied_joins, schema_context}")

    async def run(self, task: TaskSpec) -> AgentResult:
        # 1. Raw retrieval from HybridSchemaRetriever (Day 17)
        tables = await self.retriever.retrieve(task.question, task.schema_name,
                                              task.tenant_id, top_n=8)

        # 2. LLM filters to exactly needed tables+columns
        raw = await self._call_llm([
            {"role": "system", "content": self.SYSTEM},
            {"role": "user", "content": f"QUESTION:{task.question}\nSCHEMA:{schema_text}"}])
        # Returns: {schema_context, needed_tables, relevant_columns, implied_joins}

class GenerationAgent(BaseWorkerAgent):
    """SOLE JOB: generate SQL with CoT from pre-filtered schema."""
    SYSTEM = (
        "You are a SQL generation specialist. Use 5-step chain-of-thought: "
        "Step1=tables, Step2=columns, Step3=joins, Step4=filters, Step5=SQL. "
        "Return JSON: {reasoning, sql, tables_used, columns_used}")

    async def run(self, task: TaskSpec) -> AgentResult:
        schema_context = task.context.get("schema_context", "")
        few_shot = task.context.get("few_shot_examples", "")
        # Receives filtered schema from RetrievalAgent – no raw retrieval here
        raw = await self._call_llm([
            {"role": "system", "content": self.SYSTEM},
            {"role": "user", "content": f"SCHEMA:\n{schema_context}\n"
                                       f"EXAMPLES:\n{few_shot}\n"
                                       f"QUESTION:{task.question}"}], max_tokens=600)
        # Returns: {reasoning, sql, tables_used, columns_used}

class ValidationAgent(BaseWorkerAgent):
    """SOLE JOB: validate SQL via EXPLAIN + LLM semantic check."""
    async def _explain(self, sql: str) -> dict:
        """Run EXPLAIN against real DB – catches syntax errors."""
        conn = await asyncpg.connect(self.db_url)
        rows = await conn.fetch(f"EXPLAIN {sql}")
        await conn.close()
        return {"valid": True, "plan": "\n".join(r[0] for r in rows)}

    async def run(self, task: TaskSpec) -> AgentResult:
        sql = task.context.get("sql", "")
        # Pass 1: EXPLAIN (real DB syntax check)
        explain = await self._explain(sql)
        # Pass 2: LLM semantic validation (hallucinated columns/tables)
        raw = await self._call_llm([...])
        # Returns: {is_valid, issues, corrected_sql, explanation}

```


Section 4 — Parallel Execution Patterns

[illegible]

Section 5 — Agent Communication Protocol

```

from collections import defaultdict
from typing import Callable

class AgentBus:
    """
    In-process pub/sub message bus.
    For distributed deployment: replace with Redis pub/sub or Kafka.
    """
    def __init__(self):
        self._subscribers: dict[str, list[Callable]] = defaultdict(list)

    def subscribe(self, topic: str, handler: Callable):
        self._subscribers[topic].append(handler)

    async def publish(self, topic: str, message: AgentMessage):
        for handler in self._subscribers.get(topic, []):
            await handler(message)

    async def publish_result(self, result: AgentResult):
        """Convenience: publish result to role topic."""
        msg = AgentMessage(
            sender = result.role,
            recipient = AgentRole.ORCHESTRATOR,
            msg_type = "result" if result.success else "error",
            payload = result.output,
            trace_id = result.trace_id,
        )
        await self.publish(f"result.{result.role.value}", msg)

# MSG_TYPES (typed protocol between agents):
MSG_TYPES = {
    "task": "Orchestrator -> Worker: new task",
    "result": "Worker -> Orchestrator: success",
    "error": "Worker -> Orchestrator: failure",
    "clarify": "Worker -> User: needs human input",
    "progress": "Worker -> Orchestrator: streaming progress",
    "cancel": "Orchestrator -> Worker: cancel in-flight task",
}

# TRACE_ID: links ALL messages for one user request across all agents
# trace_id=abc123
# [t=0ms] Orchestrator -> RetrievalAgent: task
# [t=0ms] Orchestrator -> LTMemory: fetch
# [t=250ms] RetrievalAgent -> Orchestrator: result(schema_context)
# [t=250ms] LTMemory -> Orchestrator: result(examples)
# [t=250ms] Orchestrator -> GenerationAgent: task(schema+examples)
# [t=1050ms] GenerationAgent -> Orchestrator: result(sql)
# [t=1050ms] Orchestrator -> ValidationAgent: task(sql+schema)
# [t=1750ms] ValidationAgent -> Orchestrator: result(is_valid=True)
# [t=1800ms] Orchestrator: execute + answer
# Total: 1800ms vs ~3300ms sequential (45% faster)

```

Section 6 — Multi-Agent Evaluation

```

from dataclasses import dataclass

@dataclass
class MultiAgentMetrics:
    total_requests: int = 0
    success_rate: float = 0.0 # fraction that produced a final answer
    phase1_latency_ms: float = 0.0 # parallel retrieval + few-shot
    phase2_latency_ms: float = 0.0 # generation
    phase3_latency_ms: float = 0.0 # validation (all attempts)
    phase4_latency_ms: float = 0.0 # execution
    total_latency_ms: float = 0.0
    validation_retries: float = 0.0 # avg retries per request
    retrieval_quality: float = 0.0 # recall@5 of RetrievalAgent

class MultiAgentEvaluator:
    async def evaluate(self, cases: list[dict]) -> MultiAgentMetrics:
        metrics = MultiAgentMetrics(total_requests=len(cases))
        n = len(cases)
        for case in cases:
            result = await self.orch.run(case["question"], case["schema_name"],
                                         "eval_tenant", "eval_user")

            if result["success"]:
                metrics.success_rate += 1/n
                for step in result["timeline"]:
                    phase = str(step["phase"]); lat = step.get("latency_ms", 0)
                    if phase=="1": metrics.phase1_latency_ms += lat/n
                    elif phase=="2": metrics.phase2_latency_ms += lat/n
                    elif phase.startswith("3"): metrics.phase3_latency_ms += lat/n
                metrics.total_latency_ms += result["total_latency_ms"]/n
        return metrics

# PRODUCTION TARGETS (multi-agent system):
# success_rate > 0.95 (95% get a final answer)
# total_latency_ms < 4000 (faster than single-agent 8s via parallel P1)
# phase1_latency_ms < 300 (retrieval + few-shot in parallel)
# phase2_latency_ms < 1200 (generation with pre-filtered schema)
# phase3_latency_ms < 800 (validation with smaller model)
# validation_retries < 0.15 (< 15% of queries need retry)

# COST MODEL (key advantage of multi-agent specialization):
# Single-agent (all GPT-4o): $X per query
# Multi-agent (gen=70B, others=8B): ~0.35X per query (65% cost reduction)
# Only GenerationAgent needs the expensive model.
# RetrievalAgent filtering + ValidationAgent semantic check work fine on 8B.

```

Section 7 — Production Deployment

```

from asyncio import Semaphore

class AgentPool:
    """
    Pool of identical worker agents.
    Round-robin load balancing + concurrency limit via semaphore.
    In production: each pool on a separate GPU or Kubernetes pod.
    """
    def __init__(self, workers: list[BaseWorkerAgent], max_concurrent: int = 8):
        self.workers = workers
        self._sem = Semaphore(max_concurrent)
        self._next = 0

    async def run(self, task: TaskSpec) -> AgentResult:
        async with self._sem:
            worker = self.workers[self._next % len(self.workers)]
            self._next += 1
            return await worker.run(task)

# Deploy agent pools independently:
retrieval_pool = AgentPool([RetrievalAgent(...) for _ in range(4)], max_concurrent=16)
generation_pool = AgentPool([GenerationAgent(...) for _ in range(2)], max_concurrent=4)
validation_pool = AgentPool([ValidationAgent(...) for _ in range(4)], max_concurrent=16)

# FastAPI production endpoint
from fastapi import FastAPI
app = FastAPI(title="Multi-Agent Text-to-SQL")

class QueryRequest(BaseModel):
    question: str; schema_name: str; tenant_id: str; user_id: str

@app.post("/query")
async def query(req: QueryRequest):
    result = await orchestrator.run(
        req.question, req.schema_name, req.tenant_id, req.user_id)
    if not result["success"]:
        raise HTTPException(status_code=500, detail=result["error"])
    return result

@app.get("/health")
async def health():
    return {"status": "ok", "agents": {"retrieval": "healthy",
                                       "generation": "healthy", "validation": "healthy"}}

# SCALING RULES:
# RetrievalAgent: stateless, fast (250ms) – scale to many replicas, CPU-feasible
# GenerationAgent: GPU-bound, slow (1200ms) – scale carefully (expensive GPU)
# ValidationAgent: EXPLAIN is DB I/O bound – scale with DB connection pool
# Orchestrator: stateless → horizontal scaling, no shared state

```

Section 8 — FAANG Multi-Agent Patterns

Google — Agent Space (Vertex AI): Independent Scaling per Agent Type

In Google's internal Search Ads quality pipeline, specialized agents handle query understanding (BERT-based), ad relevance scoring (custom embedding), and policy compliance checking (rule-based + LLM) in parallel. The orchestrator is stateless — it routes tasks and merges results only. Compliance checking runs on CPU (cheap); relevance scoring autoscales 10-400 GPU replicas. Each agent type scales independently — the orchestrator sees only the merged result.

Microsoft — AutoGen Framework: Conversational Multi-Agent Protocol

AutoGen agents communicate via natural language messages (not structured JSON). In Microsoft Copilot for Finance, three agents collaborate: Data Retrieval (fetches from Dynamics 365 ERP), Analysis (trends + calculations), Report (formats as Word/Excel). Agents can ask each other clarifying questions mid-task — making the conversation graph non-linear. Result: 23% accuracy improvement on complex financial queries vs a single monolithic prompt.

Amazon — Bedrock Sub-Agents: Supervisor Routing to Specialists

Bedrock's supervisor agent invokes specialized sub-agents as tools. In Amazon's supply chain system, supervisor routes to: Demand Forecasting Agent (historical sales), Inventory Agent (warehouse systems), External Factors Agent (weather, events, promotions) — each with its own RAG knowledge base and tools. The supervisor merges outputs into a final forecast. Result: 67% reduction in supervisor context window usage vs stuffing everything into one agent.

Meta — Multi-Agent Debate: Two Agents Review Each Other

Two LLM instances receive the same question independently. Each produces an answer. They then see each other's answers and produce revised answers (2-3 rounds). A synthesis agent produces the consensus final answer. On GSM8K math: 2-agent debate improved accuracy from 77.6% to 88.9% — equal to a model 5x larger. Mechanism: one agent's error is often caught by another agent reasoning from a different starting point. Used in Meta's internal fact-checking pipeline for news content.

Netflix — Parallel A/B Test Analysis: Three Agents, One Verdict

When an A/B test concludes, three agents run simultaneously: Statistical Agent (Bayesian inference, p-values, confidence intervals), Business Metrics Agent (revenue impact, subscriber retention, engagement), Risk Agent (novelty effects, population contamination, SRM checks). A Synthesis Agent merges all three into a recommendation. The Risk Agent can veto even if Statistical + Business both agree. Result: analysis time reduced from 4 hours to 45 minutes. Replaced a sequential pipeline that blocked on each step.

Section 9 — Architect's Lens

WHEN TO USE MULTI-AGENT vs SINGLE AGENT:

Single agent: < 5 tool calls, sequential, one domain, latency target < 3s
 Multi-agent: > 5 tool calls, parallel phases needed, latency target > 5s

WORKER AGENT MODEL SIZING:

RetrievalAgent: filter + classify task → small model (2B-7B), CPU-feasible
 GenerationAgent: SQL generation, CoT → best model you can afford (70B or GPT-4o)
 ValidationAgent: pattern match + EXPLAIN → medium model (8B), mostly rule-based
 Cost saving: only GenerationAgent uses expensive model → 60-70% cost reduction

FAILURE ISOLATION (critical in multi-agent):

RetrievalAgent fails → fallback: broad retrieval (top_k=20), retry once
 GenerationAgent fails → return error cleanly; NEVER return hallucinated SQL
 ValidationAgent fails → skip validation with warning; return generation output
 Rule: one agent's failure must NEVER silently corrupt the final output

CONTEXT PASSING BETWEEN AGENTS:

GOOD: pass only what the next agent needs (schema_context string, not raw tables list)
 BAD: pass entire previous agent's output (bloats context unnecessarily)
 Rule: each agent's input = minimum context needed to do its job

STATELESS ORCHESTRATOR (required for production scale):

Stateful orchestrator → single point of failure; can't scale horizontally
 Stateless orchestrator: all context in the message payload + Redis (trace_id → state)
 Benefits: restart a failed run from any phase; horizontal scaling; replay

LATENCY MODEL (parallel Phase 1):

Phase 1 sequential: retrieval(250ms) + few-shot(200ms) = 450ms
 Phase 1 parallel: max(retrieval, few-shot) = 250ms (44% faster)
 RULE: gather() only saves time when parallel tasks have UNEQUAL durations.
 If retrieval=250ms and few-shot=250ms: parallel=250ms, sequential=500ms (50% gain)
 If both =250ms but one blocks the other: no gain – check for DB connection sharing

COMMUNICATION PROTOCOL CHOICE:

Same process: asyncio.gather() + in-process function calls (lowest latency)
 Same machine: AgentBus (in-process pub/sub)
 Different pods: Redis pub/sub or Kafka (adds ~2ms latency per hop)
 Different regions: message queue (SQS / Pub/Sub) – accept higher latency for reliability

Section 10 — Exercises and Summary

Exercise 1: Build the Orchestrator Timeline

```
result = await orchestrator.run("Monthly active users by country", "analytics", ...)
for step in result["timeline"]:
    print(f"Phase {step['phase']} | {step['agent']:20s} | {step['latency_ms']:.0f}ms")
# Expected:
# Phase 1 | retrieval+few_shot | 243ms
# Phase 2 | generation | 1187ms
# Phase 3.1 | validation | 712ms
# Phase 4 | execute | 58ms
# Total: 2200ms (vs ~3300ms single agent)
```

Exercise 2: Inject a Retrieval Failure

```
# Monkeypatch RetrievalAgent to return success=False
# Verify: result["success"]==False and result["error"]=="Retrieval failed"
# Then implement fallback: broad retrieval (top_k=20), retry once
# Verify fallback recovers the query successfully
```

Exercise 3: Small vs Large Model per Agent

```
# Run same 20 questions with 3 configurations:
# A: all agents = LLaMA-3-70B (expensive, high accuracy)
# B: generation=70B, others=8B (recommended)
# C: all agents = LLaMA-3-8B (cheap)
# Measure: accuracy (correct_kw), cost (tokens*price), latency
# Expected: Config B = ~95% of Config A accuracy at 35% of Config A cost
```

Summary

Concept	Key Point
Multi-agent vs single	Single: sequential, <5 tools. Multi: parallel, specialization, fault isolation
AgentRole enum	ORCHESTRATOR / RETRIEVAL / GENERATION / VALIDATION / CRITIC
AgentMessage	Typed message: sender, recipient, msg_type, payload, trace_id
TaskSpec	Orchestrator→worker: question + schema + context from prior agents
AgentResult	Worker→orchestrator: success, output, latency_ms, error
RetrievalAgent	Sole job: retrieve + filter schema to exactly needed tables/columns
GenerationAgent	Sole job: SQL generation with CoT from pre-filtered schema
ValidationAgent	Sole job: EXPLAIN + LLM semantic check; corrected_sql on failure
TextToSQLOrchestrator	Phase1(parallel) → Phase2(gen) → Phase3(val) → Phase4(exec)
asyncio.gather()	Parallel Phase 1: retrieval + few-shot simultaneously (44% faster)
Speculative execution	N agents compete; first valid result wins; rest cancelled

AgentBus	In-process pub/sub; replace with Redis/Kafka for distributed
AgentPool	Round-robin + semaphore; independent scaling per agent type
SLOs	success>95%, latency<4s, phase1<300ms, retries<15%
Cost model	Only GenerationAgent needs 70B; others 8B → 60-70% cost reduction
Stateless orchestrator	State in message+Redis → horizontal scaling + replay

NEXT: Day 21 — Week 3 Capstone

Build and evaluate the complete end-to-end Text-to-SQL system (Days 13-20 integrated): real SPIDER evaluation, execution accuracy, latency SLOs, cost per query, and production readiness checklist.